

UNITEDHEALTH GROUP

Common Review for JOHNSON,LUCAS AVERY BOYD

Review Date:

February 25, 2024

Review Type:

Common Review

Reviewer Type:

Self Review

Reviewer Name:

JOHNSON,LUCAS AVERY BOYD

Current:		On Review Date:	
Segment:	Optum Technology	Segment:	Optum Technology
Division:	Chief Data Office (CDaO)	Division:	CDO & Cloud Plat Eng
Job Title:	Sr Software Engineer	Job Title:	Sr Software Engineer
Grade:	28	Grade:	28
Manager Name:	MOCKUS,MICHAEL J	Manager Name:	MIN,STEVE KYUNG

Performance Summary

Marginal

Effective

Outstanding

Not Applicable

Business Goals

Title

Goal Category: Fundamental Execution

1

2

3

4

5

N/A

Operational Excellence

Description

Technical accomplishments for the Kafka platform.

Comments

This year was one of many accomplishments. Some larger than others, but it was a productive year filled with growth. The three biggest technical accomplishments for me this year were the dc-kaas-alpha migration to HCP Console, the successful management of AWS credentials for the team, and 11 more Azure Kafka cluster decommissions.

The migration of Kafka Alpha to HCP Console was my biggest and most time-consuming accomplishment of the year. From the beginning of planning in January to the end of the migration in September, I worked hard to make sure that the experience for both our team and our customers was seamless and successful. The process started with gathering necessary information from all our Alpha customers by sending out mass emails and manually following up with individuals wherever it was necessary. This included many 1:1 conversations with namespace owners to rectify any and all blockers for the migration. For the first time in my career, I found myself being the leader of a large effort for the team. Throughout the process I was planning, tracking, and delegating work for the migration effort. While working with others was not new, being the main point of contact and supporting other team members in this manner was new and rewarding. I did write quite a few scripts myself, contributing to the tooling in a big way, but I could not have done this without the help from other team members who made collaboration a breeze. The tooling consisted of over 40 individual scripts all stitched together to form a push button solution to migrate one namespace at a time. In the end we successfully migrated 369 namespaces from GitHub to Kafka Topics on Prem Alpha in HCP Console. This included thousands of Kafka resources over a span of 5 days. In those days, myself and one other engineer did the bulk of the migrating, working around the clock (OGA and US hours) to ensure the migration was finished on time. In total we spent about 140 working hours on just the migration itself over those 5 days. The migration was a huge success, and we now have a substantial amount of Kafka users interacting with the UI developed in HCP Console. I would consider this migration, start to finish over 9 months, to be my proudest accomplishment to this point.

I have now been conducting the quarterly AWS secrets rotations for almost 3 years. This is an important task for both the KaaS and CLaaS teams to maintain

UNITEDHEALTH GROUP

Review Date:

February 25, 2024

Review Type:

Common Review

Reviewer Type:

Self Review

Reviewer Name:

JOHNSON,LUCAS AVERY BOYD

Marginal

Effective

Outstanding

Not Applicable

Business Goals

good engineering security practices. The most common use of the credentials is in automation interacting with terraform and state storage in AWS. There are 11 credentials in total which need to be rotated every 90 days. As of right now there are about 75 different repositories which require updates during this process. As part of owning this I have built out, maintained and updated automation surrounding the rolling out of the new secrets every quarter. This automation streamlines the process, although there are still portions that require manual intervention. My goal during this process is to affect the team as little as possible to a point where most may not even know the rotation happened. The last year of rotations has been smooth and had no negative impact on our team.

As we near the end of life for Azure, it has been a notable accomplishment of mine to have decommissioned 11 more Azure Kafka clusters this year. Along with running the decoms, I have made multiple necessary updates to our automation to accommodate the migration of certain Azure Kafka repositories. A few clusters remain in Azure, but it has been rewarding to help move us toward our end goal of having all cloud Kafka customers in GCP and to clean up our Azure footprint.

Along with my three most notable technical contributions, there are a few smaller accomplishments I had throughout the year. I made my first contributions to the HCP Console Kafka UI, migrated the final Azure GitHub repositories from on-prem to GitHub cloud, on-boarded our team to HCP Docs, helped with peak season preparation tasks, and helped write scripts to gather support metrics for our team including Arch-Review and PR merge metrics from the last 3+ years. These accomplishments along with the larger ones above made for a year of growth in many aspects. I strive to be versatile and well-rounded as an engineer and I feel that my accomplishments this year reflect that.

Title

Goal Category: Vital Assets/People

1

2

3

4

5

N/A

Culture

Description

team collaboration wins, presentations, cross-team successes, mentorship, anything outside the team, etc

Comments

The culture on the KaaS/CLaaS teams is second to none. I find myself very fortunate to have landed on this team with such great people to work with every day. My main goal is to uphold the culture that has been built and continue to grow and pass on the same respect given to me by others. From my point of view this team does a great job of collaborating efficiently and delivering results.

When I think of my collaboration over the past year the first thing that comes to mind is the Kafka Alpha migration. Being the main point of contact for this effort gave me a perspective I had not previously had surrounding collaboration in our working environment. To put together a plan and watch it come together though the hands of multiple people was awesome. Furthermore, I was able to collaborate outside of our team with many customers due to the various blockers that needed to be cleared in order to conduct the migration. I had more engagement this year with customers than I have ever had previously. Almost all communication went well and produced the desired results. There was only a handful of times that it required escalation from other members of our team to get customers to take action.

This year in general, I feel that I was able to be a good student and get feedback as well as provide insight when desired into my areas of expertise whether it was regarding the migration or any of the other work I played part in.

Outside of normal work, I was able to take part in and complete the Optum sponsored Emerging Leaders Program. This was a 19-week program meant to introduce many leadership principles and techniques. I found it very valuable to my career progression and I think it gave me tools to move forward and confidence to lead others when given the opportunity. It also opened my eyes to how great the culture is on our team and some of the reasons why. I am proud that I went through this program and feel that it was very beneficial.

UNITEDHEALTH GROUP

Review Date:

February 25, 2024

Review Type:

Common Review

Reviewer Type:

Self Review

Reviewer Name:

JOHNSON,LUCAS AVERY BOYD

Marginal

Effective

Outstanding

Not Applicable

Business Goals

Title

Goal Category: Fundamental Execution

1

2

3

4

5

N/A

Product Management

Description

high level work to highlight, or technical/team management accomplished

Comments

As mentioned in previous sections, two initiatives that I owned this year are the Kafka Alpha migration to HCP Console and the AWS secrets rotations. The secrets rotation is something I will continue to lead year over year, but this year we had a problem free and smooth year as it relates to this. Even throughout the GHEC migration we have managed to keep misses to a minimum and have come out of this year problem free as it relates to the AWS credentials.

The majority of my focus this year was on the Kafka Alpha HCP Console migration. I took pride in being the main point of contact for this effort. There were many different aspects to oversee from customer communications to blocker resolutions, namespace clean ups, resource configuration fixes, tooling creation and all the way through the eventual migration itself. In the end, the migration milestone consisted of 110 user stories, a majority of which were created and planned by me but worked on by many. This ultimately resulted in a successful move to HCP Console and archival of the old GitHub way of managing Kafka Alpha resources.

As this year ends, I am starting the process to get the team ready to migrate GCP Kafka customers in the same manner to HCP Console.

Needs Improvement

Meets Expectations

Exceeds Expectations

Evaluation Summary

1

2

3

4

5

I feel that this year I really solidified myself and became confident as an engineer. I contributed to the team s milestones in a significate way by collaborating with peers to further improve our product. I was able to come up with the solution to the business problem of migrating KaaS Alpha and successfully delivered the result (migration tooling and the migration itself) in order to improve our customer experience. I also took the time to continue my career development and learning by going through the ELP program. Continuous growth is important to me, and I feel that I achieved that this year and am eager to continue more of the same.

UNITEDHEALTH GROUP

Review Date:

February 25, 2024

Review Type:

Common Review

Reviewer Type:

Self Review

Reviewer Name:

JOHNSON,LUCAS AVERY BOYD

Development Focus

Strengths

Collaborating

This year my collaboration really increased. I was able to learn to leverage the strengths of other members of our team to make great progress toward common goals. Working with others showed me how powerful the team can be. It was great to build new peer relationships because of the increased collaboration.

Area For Improvement

Supporting Innovation and Creativity

One area that I feel I can improve on is being more innovative. I can often come up with a solution to given problems, but I don't find myself being proactive and finding new problems outside of what is brought to me. Working on increasing my creativity and out-the-box thinking will help me advance and stand out in my career and will also help better out direct team and product ultimately.